Jarrod Tran

Lead, AI Enablement & Factory Strategy

Houston, TX | jarrodtran@outlook.com | linkedin.com/in/jarrodtran | jarrodtran.com | github.com/jarrodtran

Summary

I lead AI enablement at Tesla Energy and the product and engineering team whose tools are in production.
Earlier work covers Apple's 0-to-1 iPhone launch in India, Waymo Engineering Operations, and the 4680 program.

Experience

Tesla | Lead, AI Enablement & Factory Strategy | Aug 2023 - Present

Rejoined in 2023 after Apple and Waymo.

- Built and lead a forward-deployed AI product and engineering org, with 1,000+ active users on 20+ production AI solutions: RAG troubleshooting, automated reporting, workflow automation, and decision support.
- Own the AI enablement strategy and the reporting leadership sees. Enablement covers 10,000 employees.
- Modeled AI productivity at roughly 540 hours reclaimed per week and $1.6M in annualized value.
- Owned the global investment roadmap across California, Texas, and Shanghai. Scaled Megapack 3.2×.
- Built Python and Tableau models linking investment, labor, cost, and timing.
  We funded the work with the best return and killed the rest.
- Allocated $23M across 50+ initiatives for $156M in incremental annual profit.
- A separate program delivered $260M in annualized savings.
- Mitigated $550M in projected tariff exposure by redesigning the product and investment plan, then built and promoted successors so I could focus on AI enablement.

Waymo | Strategy & Operations Manager | Oct 2022 - May 2023

- Led annual planning, OKRs, and quarterly business reviews for Engineering Operations.
  Turned org priorities into resource plans, targets, and milestones.
- Got hardware, software, fleet, Product, Legal, and Engineering onto the same facts, including safety and regulatory work for commercial autonomous-vehicle deployment.
- Built leadership dashboards for performance, fleet health, and program milestones so senior leaders weren't stuck in ad-hoc reporting.

Apple | Strategic Operations Program Manager | Jun 2021 - Jun 2022

- Led the 0-to-1 iPhone India launch from market entry and partner qualification through readiness and scaled delivery, under tight quality, regulatory, and timing requirements.
- Supported 293% year-over-year growth (4.3M to 16.9M units) and a program whose reported revenue grew from $2B to $10B by turning demand into investment and readiness plans.
- Expanded iPhone India exports from 6 to 40+ countries and built a second-source network that reduced geographic concentration risk.

Tesla | Program Manager, Special Projects | Jun 2018 - Jun 2021

- Advanced Project Roadrunner, Tesla's 4680 program, from early pilot to a launch-ready platform, with stage gates, readiness reviews, and cross-functional ownership through Battery Day.
- Designed and launched a $3.5M per month coordination platform (Warehouse on Wheels) to protect product availability during rapid scale-up.
- Led Model 3 and Model Y planning and recovery through demand surges and supply disruptions.

Amazon | Operations Area Manager | Mar 2017 - Apr 2018

- Led a team of 100+ associates in a high-volume fulfillment center.

Education

University at Buffalo | B.S. Business Administration, Finance | Cum Laude